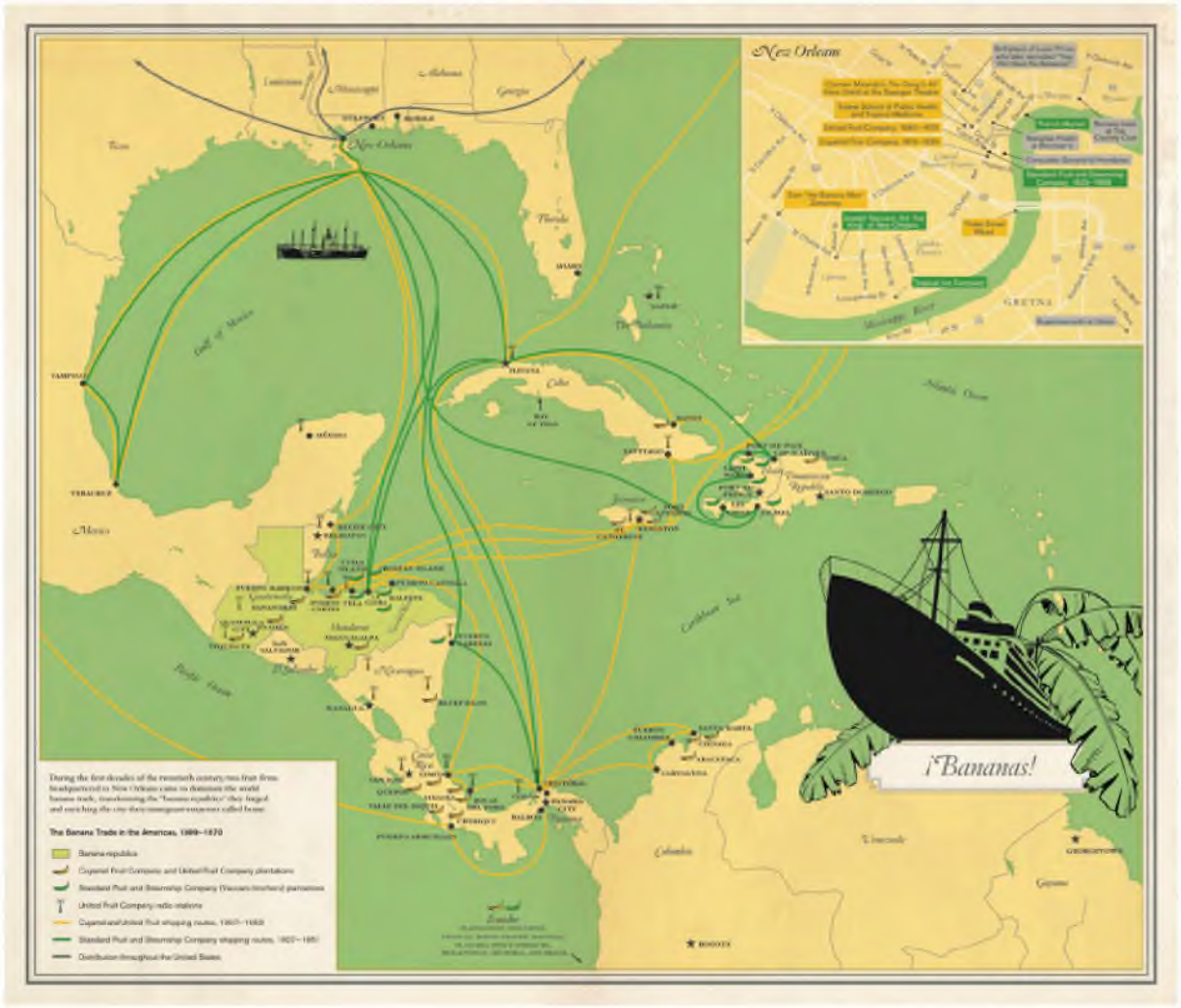
NRSM 475/591:
Environment and (International) Development



From *Unfathomable City: A New Orleans Atlas*

T, Th 3:30-4:50
Forestry 301

Instructor: Dr. Hilary Faxon
hilary.faxon@umontana.edu
Office hours T 1-2
Office: CHCB 460a

Land Acknowledgment

The University of Montana acknowledges that we are in the aboriginal territories of the Salish and Kalispel people. Today, we honor the path they have always shown us in caring for this place for the generations to come. In this course, we will discuss the the ways in which histories of colonization in and beyond the United States have impacted environment and development and how we can learn from indigenous knowledge of and relations with land.

Course Description

Why are some countries rich and other countries poor? Who gets to decide how natural resources are used, measured and valued? What do "conservation" and "sustainability" mean outside the United States? How have the uneven process of global development influenced who wins and who loses, especially in light of current challenges wrought by climate change?

This class explores these and other questions, examining how particular histories, framings and assumptions have led to different understandings of environmental and social problems and their solutions. Another way of saying this is in this class we will pay close attention to the *politics* of sustainable development. We will examine key social forces that influence how individuals, groups, and nation-states understand and live with their bio-physical environments, including processes related to capitalism, globalization, culture, class, and power relations. We will pay close attention to how both indigenous and introduced environmental values and practices in particular places variably impact people of different races, classes, genders, cultures, and livelihood practices. And we will trace the implications of these processes for current efforts to transition to clean energy, conserve biodiversity, and feed the world.

The emphasis in this course is on learning ***to understand, think, and write critically*** about social forces in environment and development. Lectures, class activities, and assignments will link theory with grounded case studies to engage with ongoing, "real" environment and development initiatives occurring all over the world today. While the course will not cover all major environment and international development issues, you will gain analytical tools to understand diverse problems and pursue a particular issue or topic of your own choosing in your final project.

After completing this course, you will be able to:

I. ***Describe*** key social forces influencing society-environment-development-conservation interactions and their historical context;

II. ***Analyze*** different theories and perspectives on the causes, consequences and potential solutions to a selection of environment and development issues today;

III. ***Evaluate*** the opportunities and challenges of different strategies, programs and policies to reconcile tensions between environment and development, and their variable costs and benefits for different social groups and ecologies.

IV. **Demonstrate enhanced writing and public speaking proficiency** through the various assignments.

Course Structure and Expectations

NRSM 475 is a 3-credit, letter grade undergrad course. NRSM 591 is a 4-credit, letter grade grad course. The courses are co-convened Tuesdays and Thursdays with an additional graduate section, which meets on Thursdays. For additional details about NRSM 591 please see "The Graduate Increment" section below.

In both courses, attendance is mandatory. Everybody gets a free pass for ***one*** unexcused absence during the semester. You will be responsible for getting notes for missed classes and doing make-up work.

Readings are mandatory. Some are challenging. It is imperative that you read and think about the material before each class so you are prepared to contribute to professional discussion. To prepare for each class, please consider:

1) what questions do you have about this reading?
2) how does this reading challenge your assumptions?
3) how does this reading connect to other readings in this course?

All readings for this course will be available on Canvas at least one week in advance.

You are expected to actively participate in class. Ask questions. All views are welcome but they must be communicated in a civil and never hostile manner.

I allow the computer use in class for notetaking. I will dock points and re-consider this policy if internet becomes a distraction. Please put away your phone in class.

All written assignments should be your own, original work. Please type in 12-point Times New Roman font. Set your margins to 1 inch. Number pages. Make sure to include your first and last name at the top of the first page. Cite references appropriately (we will talk about this). Proofread and spellcheck. Submit via Canvas.

Grading & Assignments for Undergraduates

Assignment	**Percent of Grade**	**Due Date**
Attendance and Participation	10%	Ongoing
Environment & Development news presentation	10%	1 time
Exam #1 (Essay Exam)	20%	10/10
Exam #2 (Oral Exam)	30%	wk of 11/11
Final case study project, first draft	5%	11/22
Final case study project, oral presentation	10%	12/3 & 12/5
Final case study project, second draft	15%	12/6

Assignments are due in class or at 11:59pm on the date listed. Please submit all written assignments via Canvas.

Final course grades will be determined based on the following scale:

93-100	A	73-77	C
90-92	A-	70-72	C-
88-89	B+	68-69	D+
83-87	B	63-67	D
80-82	B-	60-62	D-
78-79	C+	59-	F

The following provides an overview of course assignments for undergraduates. Additional information for graduate students is included below. Details on course assignments will be provided in class and on Canvas.

Attendance and Participation includes attendance, punctuality, attentiveness, effort, completing all readings prior to class, completing small assignments before and during class, and offering your thoughts, ideas, opinions, and questions during discussion. Your participation grade is not based on knowing the "right" answers or the quantity or length of your comments but rather your willingness to contribute, evidence that you have completed and thought through material presented in the reading, and the increasing quality of your contributions. (10%, ongoing)

Environment & International Development News Presentation: Once in the semester, post a news article that covers current events relating to environment and development. The story should be from a reliable news agency (good places to look include the international pages of *The Guardian* and *The Washington Post*, *or the main sites of Al Jazeera and Mongabay*). Your story should be international, and you should be prepared to give some context about the place it comes from. Prepare 1 slide before class, including a link to the article. In class, you will have 5 minutes to summarize the story and explain how it relates to the themes of this course. (10%, 1 slot)

Essay Exam: Complete an online essay exam remotely via Canvas during the class period that will require you to summarize, synthesize, reflect on, and apply key ideas from readings, lectures, class discussions and the virtual fieldtrip (20%)

Oral Exam: Complete an in-person oral exam testing your understanding of key concepts, approaches, and tensions in environment and development. This exam is cumulative. (30%)

Final Project: Case Study: In groups of 4, students will select an ongoing initiative, issue or organization involved in responding to the tensions between environment and development and conduct independent research. You will select a topic related to your interests and use it to apply concepts and historical knowledge and interpretation from class to assess its approach and effectiveness at resolving tensions between environment and development, or working towards creating "sustainable" and/or "resilient" societies and environment. You are required to submit a first draft, a revised draft with a short author contribution statement, and make a 10 minute PowerPoint presentation in class, followed by Q&A (5+15+10%).

The Graduate Increment

Graduate students will be expected to dive deep into the theories and practices of environment and international development. This is accomplished through additional readings, a graduate discussion section, and a higher level of sophistication, synthesis, and integration of course material in the essay exam, oral exam, and final paper.

Our discussion section meets Thursdays, 11:30-12:30 in Stone 217. It is purposefully small. Graduate students are responsible for contributing to the content of each class and to the spirit of the endeavor. Reading is very important (There is a lot of it!) Thinking is essential. (Don't plagiarize!) Ask questions to me, grapple with the texts, and talk (and listen!) to one another. Show respect. Be open to other views. Talk to me if something is inhibiting your full participation. Engaged and collective dialogue makes our class more than a stack of (great) books.

Learning Objectives

- Graduate students will be able to describe social forces influencing society-environment-development-conservation interactions and their historical and international context; analyze different theories and perspectives on the causes, consequences and potential solutions to a selection of environment and development issues today and evaluate the opportunities and challenges of different strategies, programs and policies to reconcile tensions between environment and development, and their variable costs and benefits for different social groups and ecologies at an appropriate level of sophistication.
- Graduate students will read and discuss critical theories of international development in order to gain a basic understanding of the scholarly fields of development studies and political ecology.
- Graduate students will demonstrate enhanced writing and public speaking proficiency through participation in and leadership of graduate discussion sections, including the submission of one reading response with discussion questions.

Contribution of GI to total course grade

Graduate students' grades will be determined with the following rubric.

Assignment	**Percent of Grade**	**Due Date**
Attendance & Participation	15%	Ongoing
Exam #1 (Essay Exam)	20%	10/10
Exam #2 (Oral Exam)	30%	wk of 11/11
Abstract and annotate bibliography for final paper	10%	11/22
Final paper	25%	12/6

Assignments are due in class or at 11:59pm on the date listed. Please submit all written assignments via Canvas. The letter grade scale is the same as above.

Assignments & Evaluation

The following provides an overview of course assignments for graduate students is included below. Details on course assignments will be provided in class and on Canvas.

Attendance & Participation includes attendance, punctuality, attentiveness, effort, completing all readings prior to class, completing small assignments before and during class, and offering your thoughts, ideas, opinions, and questions during Tuesday and Thursday lectures and Thursday discussion section. Your participation grade is not based on knowing the "right" answers or the quantity or length of your comments but rather your willingness to contribute, evidence that you have completed and thought through material presented in the reading, and the increasing quality of your contributions. (15%)

Essay Exam: Complete an online essay exam remotely via Canvas during the class period that will require you to summarize, synthesize, reflect on, and apply key ideas from readings, lectures, class discussions, and virtual fieldtrip. Graduate Students will be evaluated at an appropriate degree of sophistication. (20%)

Oral Exam: Complete an in-person oral exam testing your understanding of key concepts, approaches, and tensions in environment and development. This exam is cumulative. Graduate Students will be evaluated at an appropriate degree of sophistication. (30%)

Final Paper: Complete a 15-20 page paper about an environment and development topic. This assignment often works best when integrated into student thesis proposal and drafting plans. We will discuss the paper in more detail later in the semester. You will submit an abstract and annotated bibliography, then a final paper. (10%+25%)

Tentative Course Schedule

The Course Schedule will be updated on Canvas as we progress. Readings and more details will be available on Canvas at least 1 week prior to the class period for which they are assigned. Graduate students will have additional readings, to be assigned via Canvas.

Date & Topic	**Readings**
Week 1	
Aug 27 Course introduction	Rist. 'Development as a buzzword.'
Aug 29 Development debates	Podcast: If you're reading this, you're probably WEIRD (Please listen to the first 24 minutes. You are welcome, but not required, to continue) read either Sachs, Sen or Gunder Frank (Jan-April birthdays = Sachs, May-August = Sen, Sept-Dec = Gunder Frank)
	Grads please read Sachs, Sen AND Gunder Frank
Week 2	
Sep 3 Colonization	McMichael. Chapter 2 in *Development and Social Change: A Global Perspective.* Pick one animal from Animalia, read, and be prepared to share in class.
Sep 5 Institutionalization	McMichael. Chapter 3 in *Development and Social Change: A Global Perspective.* President Harry Truman's inaugural speech from 1949.
	Grads please read Woods & Naimark 2020. 'Conservation as Counterinsurgency' and Walter & Wagner 2021. 'Mining struggles in Argentina'
Week 3	
Sep 10	Woods & Naimark, 2020. 'Conservation as Counterinsurgency'
Sep 12 Virtual Fieldtrip to Argentina	Watch *Assembling Water* and the interview with Dr. Mattias Borg Rasmussen. Take notes and prepare for class discussion.

	Grads do not meet this week. Start reading *Conservation is our Government Now.*
Week 4	
Sep 17 Globalization	McMichael, Chapter 4 in *Development and Social Change: A Global Perspective.* NY Times. 'Why it Seems Everything We Knew about the Global Economy is No Longer True.'
Sep 19 Globalization	McMichael, Chapter 5 in *Development and Social Change: A Global Perspective.* • You may want to skim Chapters 6-8, which we'll cover in class. Gavin. 'What's Behind the DRC's Decision to Auction off some of its Rain Forest?'
	Grads please read *Conservation is our Government Now* (selections)
Week 5	
Sep 24 Sustainability & intro to Case Study 1	McMichael, Chapter 9 in *Development and Social Change: A Global Perspective.* Read and watch materials for the trophy hunting case (tbc)
Sep 26 Case Study 1	Read and watch materials for the trophy hunting case
	Grads please read *Conservation is our Government Now* (selections)
Week 6	
Oct 1 Population & Scarcity	Mann. Prologue and chapter 1 in *The Wizard and the Prophet: Two Remarkable Scientists and their Visions for Tomorrow's World.* (selection) NYTimes. 'How a Vast Demographic Shift will Reshape the World.'
Oct 3 Power & Participation	Chambers. 'Ideas for Development: reflecting forwards.' Part 1, p. 1-15. Leach et al. 'Sustainable Development: A gendered pathways approach,' in *Gender equality and sustainable development.*
	Grads please read Shackleton et al. 'Navigating power in conservation.'
Week 7	
Oct 8	

Rethinking (and reviewing) development	McMichael, Chapter 9 in *Development and Social Change: A Global Perspective.*
Oct 10	essay exam
Week 8	
Oct 15	Special guest, TBC
Oct 17	Special guest, TBC
	Grads please read Andrew Curley, *Carbon Sovereign'y*. Introduction and chapter 1.
Week 9	
Oct 22 Indigenous Knowledges	Andrew Curley, *Carbon Sovereign'y*. Selections. • You can find this ebook through the UM library, here Kimmerer. 'The Gift of Strawberries' in *Braiding Sweetgrass*.
Oct 24 Indigenous Knowledges	Andrew Curley, *Carbon Sovereign'y*. Selections. • You can find this ebook through the UM library, here Kimmerer. 'Learning the Grammar of Animacy' in *Braiding Sweetgrass*.
	Grads please finish Curley and read Farrell et al. 'Effects of land dispossession and forced migration on Indigenous peoples in North America.'
Week 10	
Oct 29 Case Study 2	Read and watch materials for the Lithium case
Oct 31 Case Study 2	Read and watch materials for the Lithium case
	Grads read *The War Below* (selections)
Week 11	
Nov 5 Case Study 3	Read and watch materials for the Agrarian Change in Greece case
Nov 7 Case Study 3	Read and watch materials for the Agrarian Change in Greece case \

	Grad please read *Stuffed & Starved* (selections).
Week 12	No class this week. Oral Exams. Meet with your group to select your case study.
Week 13	
Nov 19 Climate Justice	Forbes (selections)
Nov 21 Geoengineering	Watch '[On Collaborative Geoengineering]" by Holly Jean Buck
	Grads read *After Geoengineering* (selections)
Week 14	
Nov 26	Group work/meetings about first draft of case study.
Nov 28	No Class – Thanksgiving
Week 15	
Dec 3 Final presentations	Student presentations
Dec 5 Final presentations	Student presentations
	Grads: final paper workshop

Course Policies

Please familiarize yourself with, and follow, the student conduct code:
https://www.umt.edu/student-affairs/community-standards/default.php

Attendance Policy

Students with more than three unexcused absences will result in a zero in participation (and thus a 10% reduction in the student's final grade). More than six unexcused absences will automatically result in an F in the course, with no options to do make-up assignments. HOWEVER, in cases where students have family or medical emergencies, or other legitimate reasons for missing class, I am willing to make alternative arrangements for make-up assignments on a case-by-case basis. Please communicate with me if something is interfering with your attendance so we can troubleshoot!

Late Assignments

Points will be deducted (the later you turn them in, the more points you will lose), but better late than never definitely applies (i.e. it's better to get some credit for an assignment rather than none at all). If you have a family or medical emergency, or another legitimate reason to submit assignments late, please talk with me as soon as possible.

Cultural Leave Policy
Cultural or ceremonial leave allows excused absences for cultural, religious, and ceremonial purposes to meet the student's customs and traditions or to participate in related activities. To receive an authorized absence for a cultural, religious or ceremonial event the student or their advisor (proxy) must submit a formal written request to the instructor. This must include a brief description (with inclusive dates) of the cultural event or ceremony and the importance of the student's attendance or participation. Authorization for the absence is subject to approval by the instructor. Appeals may be made to the Chair, Dean, or Provost. The excused absence or leave may not exceed five academic calendar days (not including weekends or holidays). Students remain responsible for completion or make-up of assignments as defined in the syllabus, at the discretion of the instructor.

Academic Honesty and Plagiarism
All students must practice academic honesty. That means, among other things, that any work submitted by a student in this course must be the student's own work, not ChatGPT's. You are encouraged to study together and to discuss information and concepts covered in lecture and the sections with other students, but permissible cooperation should never involve copying. Academic misconduct is subject to an academic penalty by the course instructor and/or a disciplinary sanction by the University. All students need to be familiar with the Student Conduct Code. Please be aware that plagiarism is a violation of the student conduct code and will not be tolerated in this course. If a student plagiarizes, their course grade will be impacted and the UM Dean of Students will be notified. If you aren't entirely certain what constitutes plagiarism is, please see these excellent resources:

Plagiarism Web Link
Writing Center Link
Owl English Purdue Link
Owl English Purdue Resource Link

Resources for Students

Advising
I encourage you to come to my office during office hours or email to set up an appointment. Talk with me as soon as you have questions or difficulties with the material. Do not wait until the day before an exam or an assignment is due.

Important Dates Restricting Opportunities to Drop a Course Fall 2024
Please see this webpage for information on drop deadlines:
https://www.umt.edu/registrar/calendar/autumn/default.php

Tutoring
There are many resources on campus for tutoring to provide support for courses:
https://www.umt.edu/oss/for-students/tutoring.php

Writing Support
The University of Montana Writing Center welcomes all students in all disciplines to take advantage of free support as they write for any course. To make an appointment and learn more about The Writing Center's by-appointment and drop-in hours, visit: https://www.umt.edu/writing-center//

Equal Access to Instruction and Office of Disability Equity
The University of Montana assures equal access to instruction through collaboration between students with disabilities, instructors, and the Office for Disability Equity (ODE). If you anticipate or experience barriers based on disability, please contact the ODE at: (406) 243-2243, ode@umontana.edu, or visit www.umt.edu/disability for more information. Retroactive accommodation requests will not be honored, so please, do not delay. As your instructor, I will work with you and the ODE to implement an effective accommodation, and you are welcome to contact me privately.

Mental Health Resources
University of Montana provides resources to support your mental health and wellbeing through Curry Health Center. Check out this link to see a full list of resources: https://www.umt.edu/wildlife-biology/resources/mental-health-resources.php

Career Readiness
The Franke College of Forestry and Conservation is committed to the career success of our students and encourages you to participate in ElevateU – UM's signature career readiness program – to ensure that you graduate career-ready, with the education, skills, and tools needed to launch, carry-on, and pivot your post-graduation career. Participation in ElevateU is free and can be started at any time, no matter where you are in your academic or career journey. Get started by creating a profile on Handshake to search for jobs and internships or by scheduling an appointment with an Experiential Learning and Career Success (ELCS) career coach or advisor.

Food and Housing Insecurity
Any student who faces challenges securing food or housing, and believes that this could affect their performance in this course, is urged to contact any or all of the following:

Food Pantry Program
UM offers a food pantry that students can access for emergency food. The pantry is open on Tuesdays from 12 to 5 PM and Fridays from 10 AM to 5 PM. The pantry is located in UC 119 (in the former ASUM Childcare offices). Pantry staff operate several satellite food cupboards on campus (including one at Missoula College). For more information about this program, email **umpantry@mso.umt.edu**, visit the **UM Food Pantry website** or contact the pantry on social media (@pantryUm on twitter, @UMPantry on Facebook, um_pantry on Instagram).

ASUM Renter Center
The Renter Center has compiled a **list of resources** (https://medium.com/griz-renter-blog) for UM students at risk of homelessness or food insecurity. Students can schedule an appointment with Renter Center staff to discuss their situation and receive information, support, and referrals.

TRiO Student Support Services

TRiO serves UM students who are low-income, first-generation college students or have documented disabilities. TRiO services include a textbook loan program, scholarships and financial aid help, academic advising, coaching, and tutoring. Students can **check their eligibility** (www.umt.edu/triosss/apply.php) for TRiO services online.

Legal Support

Students can get free legal advice. To learn more: https://www.umt.edu/asum/agencies/legal/

Office of Equal Opportunity and Title IX

The Office of Equal Opportunity and Title IX supports UM's commitment to diverse and inclusive working and learning environments free from all forms of discrimination, harassment, and sexual misconduct. We work to eliminate barriers inhibiting individuals from achieving their full potential in education, employment, and other programs at the University. To learn more: https://www.umt.edu/equal- opportunity-title-IX/